



Fujitsu Palm Secure biometric system

surveillance cameras.

These can be further divided into two categories, wired and wireless. Wireless technology may come in handy where wiring is not possible, or is not desired—such as in already built-up houses. Wired security systems can be planned for houses that are still under construction. Wireless technology is a little costlier than wired but is non-obtrusive as its wiring is not visible to the intruders.

Type and form factor. A home can be protected by putting alarms wherever necessary. Other than alarms, you can have an electromagnetic door locking system. Today, door locking systems come with both audio and video capabilities, so you can see who is standing at the door before opening it. Depending on the size of your house, cameras can be used to scan the entire area. When choosing the system, also consider whether you need recording capability.

Alarm system. Alarms can be used to frighten away the burglars. They can be made to sound whenever a door or window is opened at night while you are sleeping. Alarms can have mild pitch or they can be very loud.

An alarm system basically comprises a central control unit, which can be considered as its brain, and various sensors placed at different locations. Whenever a sensor detects any unwanted activity in its vicinity, a signal

is sent to the central control unit.

Mansi Shankar, director, Digitals India Security Products, says, "For an integrated alarm, one should look at the number of zones, battery backup, line-cut proof system, auto dialling and system test feature. The system should also be tamperproof."

There are various alarm systems that come with auto dialler which is connected to the central control unit. So whenever the control unit receives any signal from the sensors, it sends an automated message to the desired number. The phone number can be preprogrammed and even the recording can be customised.

When buying an alarm, check whether it is battery-powered or line-powered. It should not provide any false alarm, and be easy to install and user-friendly. Look at the types of sensors that will be used at various places.

Passive infrared (PIR) sensors work by detecting body movement or body heat. Therefore these can be used when no one is in the house. Magnetic sensors come in two parts and are easy to use. These can be used to check intrusion through doors and windows.

Camera. Various types of cameras are available in the market, including dome cameras, IR cameras for night vision and IP-based cameras for remote surveillance. While some

cameras are designed for scanning the vicinity during day time only, the others can be used at night also.

Shankar says, "For a CCTV (closed-circuit TV) system, one should look at camera resolution, CE or FCC certification, DVR (digital video recorder) with H.264 compression, Pentaplex operation and VGA TV output."

Cameras can be connected to a VCR or to a computer to record everything observed by them. These can have inbuilt microphones or else microphones can be installed besides them so that whatever the intruder speaks can be heard. IP-based cameras can be used to monitor your home from any remote place. Night-vision cameras can be used to keep track of intrusions at night.

Other security systems. Apart from alarms and cameras, you can use electromagnetic locks, PIR lights and switches to protect your house. PIR lights work in the same way as PIR sensors, i.e., whenever there is any movement in their vicinity, they trigger an alarm or just light up—some doing both.

Srenivasan P.R., CEO, Mark Global Inc., says, "Before buying any security system, look for what purpose you want to purchase a security system.

IR cameras are better for all outdoor requirements. Go for a camera with minimum of 470 TV lines for better resolution. Ensure DVR capability. Opt for a



AXIS M1031-W network surveillance camera